

Jira Delivery Workflow & Handoff Model

A visible operating model for ownership, status integrity, QA/UAT handoffs, release control, and traceable evidence.

PORTFOLIO ARTIFACT QS-02	SCOPE Enterprise Salesforce Delivery	EDITION Sanitized / Generalized
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PURPOSE

Standardize how work moves through Jira so the board reflects the true delivery state, the next accountable owner, the evidence supporting each handoff, and the remaining risk.

Operating Rules

PRINCIPLE	WORKING RULE
Visible ownership	The assignee reflects the person responsible for the next active action—not the person who last touched the ticket.
Evidence before movement	A status change confirms its entry conditions are satisfied; required notes and evidence move with the ticket.
Quality starts early	QA participates in refinement, prepares while development is active, and independently assesses the completed change.
Business owns acceptance	QA validates functionality and risk; the authorized business/UAT owner decides operational acceptance.
Release is controlled	The approved candidate is promoted through staging and production with deployment, rollback, monitoring, and validation evidence.
Backward movement is healthy	Work returns to the responsible stage when a defect, missing requirement, data issue, or unacceptable risk is discovered.

BOARD INTEGRITY

Never move a ticket simply to make a sprint report look complete. Jira should show the true current state, owner, blocker, and residual risk.

Recommended Story Workflow

The story record shows what was defined, built, tested, and accepted.

#	JIRA STATUS	PRIMARY OWNER	STATUS MEANS
1	Draft / Intake	Business / Product / BA	Request captured and awaiting initial triage.
2	Ready for Refinement	Product / BA	Business context and draft behavior are ready for cross-functional review.
3	Ready for Sprint	Product + Delivery Team	Definition of Ready is met; item may be considered for commitment.
4	In Development	Developer	Implementation and QA preparation are active.
5	Code Review	Developer / Reviewer	Peer review, unit checks, and correction are underway.
6	Ready for QA	Assigned QA Tester	Correct build, self-test evidence, data, and handoff notes are available.
7	In QA	QA	Independent functional, regression, permission, data, and defect assessment are active.
8	QA Complete	QA	QA outcome, coverage, evidence, known issues, and residual risk are recorded.
9	Ready for UAT	Assigned UAT Tester	Business tester, scope, access, data, instructions, and QA context are confirmed.
10	In UAT	UAT Tester / Business Owner	Business users validate realistic operational workflows.
11	UAT Accepted	Business Owner	Authorized acceptance or conditional acceptance is documented.
12	Done	Product / Team	Definition of Done and required closure conditions are satisfied.

Exception Statuses

Blocked · QA Failed · UAT Failed · Reopened · Deferred · Cancelled · Accepted Risk

Each exception requires a reason, accountable owner, next action, and—when appropriate—a decision date or retest path.

Handoff Control Matrix

Every responsibility change must be visible in status, assignment, and evidence.

HANDOFF	SENDER PROVIDES	RECEIVER CONFIRMS	JIRA CHANGE
Business → Product/BA	Problem, desired outcome, urgency, users, and context.	Triage validity, scope path, priority, and owner.	Assignee = Product/BA; status = Draft / Intake
Product/BA → Refinement	Story, draft criteria, process/data notes, open questions.	Review from product, technical, and QA perspectives.	Status = Ready for Refinement
Planning → Developer	Ready criteria, sprint goal, dependencies, test owners.	Accept implementation ownership and surface blockers.	Sprint set; status = In Development; assignee = Developer
Developer → QA	Correct build, self-test, data/setup, version, notes, limitations.	Perform entry check; visibly accept or reject the handoff.	Status = Ready for QA; assignee = QA; handoff comment
QA → UAT	QA outcome, coverage, defects, evidence, build, limitations, risk.	Acknowledge scope/access/data; execute business scenarios.	Status = Ready for UAT; assignee = UAT tester
UAT → Release	Authorized acceptance/conditions; approved scope.	Create candidate, release controls, window, and promotion plan.	Status = UAT Accepted; release link / version set
Release → Operations	Exact candidate, deployment/rollback steps, smoke tests, monitoring, contacts.	Confirm window, access, observability, and response readiness.	Release status = Approved for Production / Deploying

NO SILENT HANDOFFS
Moving the card and changing the assignee are both required. The receiving owner should not need to search chat to learn which build, environment, data, scope, or limitation applies.

Release Workflow

Use a linked release record to control promotion and production decisions across multiple approved stories.

RELEASE STATUS	REQUIRED MEANING	PRIMARY OWNER
Release Planning	Scope, dependencies, target window, change owners, communication, and release owner identified.	Release Lead / Product
Release Candidate	Approved work assembled into one identifiable candidate linked to the release.	Release / DevOps
Ready for Staging	Deployment, configuration, data migration, smoke, monitoring, support, and rollback plans complete.	Release Lead
In Staging	Candidate deployed to staging; release validation active.	Release + QA
Staging Complete	Results, known issues, deviations, and residual risk documented.	QA / Release
Release Decision	Authorized stakeholders issue Go, Conditional Go, Partial Release, No-Go, or Reschedule.	Business / Product / Release
Approved for Production	Window, exact version, owners, communications, monitoring, and rollback readiness confirmed.	Release Authority
Deploying	Approved production change in progress; logs monitored.	Release / DevOps
Production Validation	Safe smoke testing, monitoring, and data/integration verification active.	Operations + QA Support
Closed	Deployment outcome, evidence, incidents, rollback/hotfix actions, and follow-up work complete.	Release Lead / Product

ARTIFACT INTEGRITY

Promote the same approved release candidate through staging and production whenever technically possible. Any material rebuild, configuration change, or scope change requires impact review and appropriate revalidation.

Backflow and Quality Gates

CONDITION	TICKET ACTION	RETURN OWNER	REQUIRED RECORD
Missing / untestable requirement	Return to Ready for Refinement or mark Blocked.	Product / BA	Question, decision owner, due date, updated criteria
Build / handoff incomplete	Reject Ready for QA; return to development or code review.	Developer	Missing gate item and correction needed
QA defect	Set QA Failed / Blocked and link defect.	Developer	Reproduction, severity, evidence, build/environment
Environment / data issue	Use Blocked; do not automatically classify as product defect.	Environment / Data Owner	Impact, owner, workaround, expected restoration
UAT issue	Set UAT Failed / Reopened; classify defect vs training/policy/preference.	Product/BA + Developer	Business impact, expected behavior, disposition, retest owner
Staging failure	Hold candidate / issue No-Go and revalidate affected scope.	Release / Dev / QA	Failed step, candidate version, impact, correction, retest evidence
Production failure	Open incident and invoke rollback/hotfix criteria.	Operations / Release	Timeline, logs, decision, recovery, user/data impact
Accepted risk	Proceed only with written authorization.	Named Decision Owner	Risk, rationale, impact, workaround, review/target date

Quick Gate Checks

GATE	CHECK
STORY READY	Outcome/owner clear; measurable criteria; scope boundaries; data/roles/integrations; dependencies; UAT owner; small enough to complete.
READY FOR QA	Peer review; correct build; dev checks; data/services; version/notes; limitations; QA assigned.
QA COMPLETE	Critical scenarios; regression; defects current; blocked areas disclosed; evidence; residual risk; QA outcome.
READY FOR UAT	UAT tester; access/data; business scenarios; QA context; known issues; decision authority; schedule.
RELEASE READY	UAT decision; release link; candidate identifiable; staging plan; rollback/monitoring; scope frozen; risk visible.
PRODUCTION COMPLETE	Deployment logs; critical smoke; integrations/jobs healthy; monitoring active; incident/rollback disposition; outcome recorded.

PORTFOLIO SANITIZATION NOTE

This portfolio edition is a generalized adaptation of an enterprise quality operating model. Institutional names, logos, internal ticket identifiers, personnel, URLs, environment names, proprietary fields, and implementation-specific details have been removed or generalized. The artifact is presented to demonstrate quality engineering method, governance, and leadership practice.